

A PHOTOREALISTIC COMIC

SPREADING HAPPINESS

The complete lecture retold in panels



THE SONGSTER AND THE MAZIK



RABBI MILLER

Part I. The Songster and the Mazik Bird Bias In this week's sedrah, there's a mitzvah of shiluach hakan. Everyone knows that when you come to a nest and you find a mother bird and little birds or eggs, so you cannot take the mother bird together with the young.



RABBI MILLER

Send Away The Mother Bird.



RABBI MILLER

The Young May Then Be Taken.



RABBI MILLER

The Bird Continues Her Song.

שלח תשלח את האם - ואת הבנים תקח לך

THE WORLD'S SONGSTERS



RABBI MILLER

should have to spare the mother? Why is the bird the one lucky creature that was chosen for this benefit of saving the mother bird? The World's Songsters So listen to what the Medrash (Devarim Rabbah 6:5) says about this subject. It's because the bird is busy all the time *yu ipn iip iy* - with making the world a happier place. The bird deserves special treatment because it's *mesameyach es habriyos*, it sings and causes joy to the world. Now, we have to pay attention to that Medrash because it's a very important statement.



RABBI MILLER

Everything in Medrash is important, but there's a very big lesson here. Suppose you walk out tomorrow morning and you see a bird standing on a branch and it's chirping. The sun is shining, the bird is singing, and it makes you think, "Maybe there is something to sing about, after all." You know when people want to show there's a happy world, they show a bird singing. The bird is a symbol of happiness. The fact is that poets note it; other people who are wide awake note it.



RABBI MILLER

And that's because it's noteworthy: the chirping of the birds in the trees is a contribution to the happiness of life. Now it may not be a major contribution - I cannot tell you how big it is because I have never been in a world without birds -but there's no question, when the spring starts coming in and again the birds are singing or chirping or whatever they're doing, it causes a certain joy in the hearts. Now, why the bird is singing, it could be that it's just a signal.

וְהָלַכְתָּ בְּדַרְכָּיו



RABBI MILLER

Maybe the bird is saying, "Jake, bring the worms here," or something else, I can't tell you; but as far as we're concerned, the bird is singing and adding to our happiness. So Hakadosh Baruch Hu says, "You're *niy u ipn iia poiy* and therefore I'm going to give you a special privilege. We need to confer on you this benefit more than all other animals.

THE HAPPINESS MACHINE



RABBI MILLER

are a lot of things to be done in life, but among them is a career of making others happy; that man is performing one of the most important achievements that he could do for himself. And that's one of the secrets of the mitzvah of shiluach hakan; it's intended as a model lesson. If because a bird chirps in the trees, Hakadosh Baruch Hu designated the birds for the mitzvah of sending away the mother bird, then suppose a man who doesn't do things by instinct - he follows his free will and his reason; he lives by seichel-- and by means of his intellect he chooses to make people happy, then how much more does he deserve.



RABBI MILLER

And so Hashem says, If you'll be a songster in the world, 'I'll watch because they're the songsters, and people will like you too - but I'll also go out of My way to reward you. I'll have rachmanus on you and spare you from troubles the same way the mother bird songster is spared, because you're doing My work in the world.' The Original Happiness Spreader Now, that's an important point and I want to stress it again before we continue. It's not merely a matter of imitating the birds -it's Hashem's work that you're doing; only that birds are a reminder, a symbol, a lesson, a model.



RABBI MILLER

Actually, you're emulating Hashem. 77 -You're walking in His Ways (Devarim 28:9) because Hashem, after all, He's the One Who spreads happiness. That's His entire creation. Like Dovid Hamelech said, "nnx'-I came to the conclusion, (Tehillim 89:3). He studied the world and he was thinking, what are happiness. What is rain for? Happiness. Everything is for the purpose of chessed.. Now, we didn't have to wait until Tehillim to hear such a tremendous and fundamental statement that the world was created for kindness. It's an open possuk in the Torah, right in the beginning: n x xp iu nni nuy ux - Hashem saw all that He made and behold it was very good. Good"means it causes happiness; that everything is for the purpose of causing joy to mankind



RABBI MILLER

Fish, Wool And Cotton.

את כל אשר עשה והנה טוב מאד

THE FIRST RUNG



RABBI MILLER

Details of Happiness You want to be convinced? Just walk outside in the street and look at the soil in the gardens, on the sidewalk. It's a remarkable creation covering the earth that is kul o chessed. In every tablespoon of soil you have more living things than you have people in Greater New York. Fungi and bacteria in the millions -all for the purpose of making things grow. And that's a big happiness because when you sat down this evening at your table, if you had bread on the table, it's a simcha to chew on that. Ah! It's fun to eat! Come on, own up!



RABBI MILLER

Admit it, it's fun! I'm not saying you should look for gourmet but a piece of bread is an immense happiness. And everything is like that. Chickens are laying eggs every day. A remarkable animal, the chicken. And the purpose is for us to eat. Why do we have oceans? Pass by a fish store and you'll see why there are oceans. The world lives off of fish. In the oceans there's a harvest; every day, hundreds of thousands of pounds of fish are being taken out for people to eat. And so the world is busy eating, busy enjoying Hashem's creation. All of creation is supplying mankind happiness.



RABBI MILLER

It's a happiness to wear clothing, no? That's why cotton is always growing. Linen is growing. The sheep are constantly producing wool. The cow is producing leather for your shoes. Even the air is made for happiness. It's a cocktail, a special mixture of gases that invigorates you when you breathe it in. So the whole world is under a mantle of two hundred miles of chessed, two hundred miles of air! The Happiness Machine In your own body, too, everything functions for your happiness. Your heart is pumping so that you should be happy. Your liver and your kidneys are for happiness. Your tongue, your taste buds, your teeth.



RABBI MILLER

Everything. Let's say you're sad, you're worried. So you go to sleep and the next day you wake up in the morning and you forgot all about your troubles. Hakadosh Baruch Hu causes us consolation during the night. While you sleep, all your worries go away, or many do. 2 w x -He heals the broken hearts, nixy? wan pi - and He binds up their pains (Tehillim 147:3). Hashem causes people to forget sad experiences. If somebody had a great tragedy, chal i lah, as time passes by he forgets it.

TURN FROM EVIL



RABBI MILLER

he forget it? He should weep all of his days. No. Hakadosh Baruch Hu certain antigens that battle against the sadness and return him to his equilibrium, his happiness. And so there's no end to things in life that Hashem gives to make people happy-more than anything else, of all the things we see as we look in the world, the one most conspicuous fact is that the Creator is interested in bestowing on mankind good times. And if that's the way of Hakadosh Baruch Hu in the universe then when it's stated in the Torah, , that you should walk in His ways, spreading happiness must be included in our way of living.



RABBI MILLER

The singing bird is a reminder, a lesson, but Hashem is our Model. The Sur Mei'ra Rung And so we'll start from the bottom of the ladder. The ladder of first rung is? The very first step is not to do harm to anybody. Now, you might say, "Oh, that's superfluous." Like somebody told me, "What is there to know about not harming people?" He wants to hear about the successful career of how to spread happiness to all the way and speaking about not being a mazik?



RABBI MILLER

Is that really necessary? And the answer is yes. It takes a great deal of study, a good amount of being aware and being careful, in order to stand on that first rung and balance yourself properly. You have to learn Bava Kamma, a big Me sich ta. You have to learn Bava Met zia, a big Me sich ta. Bava Basra, an even bigger Me sich ta. And all of that comes first because it's u po opun u naa fm u a iau a 34:15).



RABBI MILLER

Sharing Germs We're harming people constantly! Here, you come over to a man when you have a cold, you give him a shalom a lei chem. You grasp his too. As you're talking - cough, cough, cough, cough. I shy away from him, but he comes closer. Some people talk only into your nose.

THE HOLY HOLD-UP MAN



RABBI MILLER

Sharing Germs. We're harming people constantly! Here, you come over to a man when you have a cold and give him a shalom aleichem. You grasp his hand too. As you're talking - cough, cough, cough, cough. I shy away from him, but he comes closer. Some people talk only into your nose. They bend their heads over to you to confer a gift of bacteria on you. That's a mazik! If you have a cold, then keep away from people.



RABBI MILLER

The Two-Legged Gazlan. Also included in this is other people's property. If you pick up a sefer and learn in it without permission from the owner, you're a gazlan. You have no right to take a sefer; in halacha it states that you cannot borrow without his permission because, as you move the pages, they sometimes tear (Orach Chaim 14:4). A tallis, the poskim say, you can borrow on condition that you'll fold it up again (ibid.). Otherwise, you have no right to borrow it without his knowledge. And if he's a finicky man who doesn't like the idea of his tallis up against somebody else's neck, then you can't borrow it either (see Mishnah Berurah, ibid.).



RABBI MILLER

Or like I saw someone learning in the yeshiva: he was sitting on somebody's chair - it's not his; he's borrowing it from the yeshiva - and instead of sitting on the four legs, he'd like to have a little ride, so he tilts it back and forth on two legs. It's not made for that. It's not a rocking chair. He's loosening the glue in the joints; he's mekatzer the yamim of that chair. That's a serious matter! He's a mazik! He's reading in a sefer, maybe about being mesameyach es habriyos, and meanwhile he's not even on the first rung.



RABBI MILLER

The Holy Hold-Up Man. Now I'll add some more to that. Suppose a man is going to selichos. I once saw an elderly rabbi with a walking stick that had a silver head on it, wearing a kapote. He was a talmid chacham, a moreh horaah, and he was accompanied by two of his disciples. He was going to the mikvah before selichos. It was about 5:30 in the morning. He was talking at the top of his voice. He was talking divrei Torah, I'm sure, divrei hisorerus - but he's a mazik. He's a gazlan. Rav Yisrael Salanter said that if you steal sleep, you're a gazlan who can never make restitution. You can't give back what you stole from that person.

THE BENEFICIAL SONGSTER



RABBI MILLER

said if you steal sleep, you're a gaz lan who can never make restitution. You can't give back what you stole from that person. going to selichos. I'm going to the mikvah. I'm talking divrei Torah"- he doesn't realize he's a robber. You're a hold-up man! People are sleeping! Because you want to go to selichos, you can rob people of their sleep?! R'Yisrael Salanter said that. Stealing people's time, too. If you're an employee, you can't waste the time of your employer.



RABBI MILLER

He paid you! There are certain conventions, maybe, certain things that by usage we understand you have a right to do. You can go to the bathroom, yes. But you can't sit in the bathroom and read the newspaper. These people are gazlanim. They're mazikim. A Sea of Information And so, if you begin the study of the subject, you'll see it's almost endless. There's so much sur mei'ra to be careful with, and it's a subject as wide as these a-the Yam Ha Talmud.



RABBI MILLER

The first rung - the subject of not causing injury to other people not making unhappiness in the world, not causing dissension, not speaking rechilus, lashon hara, onaas devarim-all these things are entire Me sich t as of wisdom. It means sef a rim upon sef a rim and practice upon practice. But we'll leave them out now because we want to go on to the second rung. Part II. The Beneficial Songster Beyond Lollipops So let's imagine that we all graduated from the first rung and we're maybe you can walk around giving out lollipops to people - I imagine that such a thing would make people happy; at least children and maybe the dentists, too - but that's not enough. There are much bigger things than that.

הוי מקבל את כל האדם בסבר פנים יפות



RABBI MILLER

A Kind Face Lifts A Spirit.

A PLEASANT FACE



RABBI MILLER

1:15). Not because it's a mitzvah and you want mitzvos; do it because it makes them happy. And not only happy, it makes them healthy, too. The Gemara (Kes u vos Ilib) says that if you flash your teeth at your fellow man it's like giving him an injection of vitamins. A healthy person is happy. You're a spreader of happiness now! Guilty as Charged Now some people, I'm sorry to say, not only they're not fulfilling pass by a man who knows you and he greets you and you nod with a glum face? You have harmed him. You hurt his feelings.



RABBI MILLER

You added some unhappiness to the world. Now, it could be you're not intending anything wrong; you're not trying to show disapproval of him as you pass by him. Maybe your stomach is bothering you or you're worried about where to get the next month's rent from. But still, he doesn't know what's on your mind. All he sees is that you pass him with a glum face. You're a mazik. It means that when you walk into your house and your wife sees a glum face, you're harming her. When a wife serves supper to her husband with a grim face, she's harming him.



RABBI MILLER

That's still before the first rung. If at least you had a neutral face; but a glum face? Even if you're worried about your sins and you're full of hi rh ure i tesh uva h, but if you're wearing a scowl because of that, then you're guilty. R'Y isro el Salanter said that. He was walking in the street and a man who was coming from s eli chos passed by him; a yare i, af rum Jew, and his face was still wet with tears. Rav Y isro el was a young man and he greeted this man, but the man didn't answer him.



RABBI MILLER

The man was so immersed in his thoughts of repentance for his sins - he was contrite and sad - that he ignored this young man who greeted him. blame that you're a frum Jew? Do I have to suffer because of your f rum ke it? You're a mazik!" He didn't say that; I'm adding these words. He just said, "Is it my fault that you are frum?" And so the number one requirement in our songster program is your face. Utilize it! You have to use your face properly in this world.

WORDS THAT BUILD



RABBI MILLER

face is given to you not that you should just paste it on your skull and then let it stay there. You have to manipulate that face for this program. A Detail on the Face And now we come to something that's built into your face. It's your mouth. Words! How important it is to say good words, happy words mesameyach es habriyos words! You know people have a way of saying nasty words constantly. Sometimes a husband or a wife can make life Gehenom with their words.



RABBI MILLER

A foreman who is saying mean words constantly to the people under him or an employer who says mean words. They're mazikim. Ona'as devarim, hurting people's feelings, is one of the very biggest sins! But even if you're perfectly quiet and you don't say one mean word, that's only the bottom rung. Because to climb means that you want to be a songster. Now, it doesn't mean you have to set up shop on a corner and play a banjo, but you have to say words that make people happy.



RABBI MILLER

Say, "Good morning" as you pass by. But say it so that he should hear you. After dave nen, say to your fellow man, "Good morning! Shalom lei chem. (The Rav said it slowly and enunciated the syllables.) Don't say it as if you're sick, chas v'shalom, as if you're expiring. Say it even if you're not. You're doing a mitzvah, mesameyach es habriyos. Complimentary Happiness Now, if you can say an encouraging word, a compliment, even better. When your wife gives you supper and you taste the soup, say, "The soup is delicious even if it's not, say it anyh

וְהוּא מְקַבֵּל אֶת כָּל הָאָדָם בְּשִׂמְחָה



RABBI MILLER

Or whatever it is that she made, compliment it! And don't be stingy! Be lavish! And the same is with everybody else. Always say encouraging words. Believe me, people are just waiting for it. Don't worry. Everybody will believe it. When you say to your fellow man, "I'm happy to see you, he believes it. And you have added to his well-being.

SPREADING WEALTH



RABBI MILLER

Spreading the Wealth You remember when Rebi was sitting in his yeshiva, surrounded by his sages and a rich man walked in. So Rebi said, "nyn 7 ipn mn-Make a place for this rich man" (Eiruv in 85b). All the sages moved over. This man wasn't a great talmid chacham, but they moved over and gave him a seat. Then a man who was even wealthier came in and Rebi said, Make a place for this wealthier man! They gave him a better seat up front. we know why you honor wealthy people, but that wasn't Rebi's purpose, because Rebi was so wealthy himself that all the rest were like beggars compared to him.



RABBI MILLER

Rebi was a millionaire. So why did he honor wealthy people? He didn't want anything from them. And the Gemara says it's because the wealthy person gives more tzedakah. He's making people happy! Now, maybe he can't help it. He's being bothered constantly so he gives more. And it could be that there's a poor man who would like to give, but he doesn't have the ability; it's not his fault. Still, the man who is given wealth from which he's able to do more to make men happy, it's a special privilege given to him min ha Shamayim.



RABBI MILLER

Not only the mitzvah of tzedakah; even more, it's the zechus of being mesameyach e shab r iyo s. Appreciating the Happiness Spreaders And so we begin to understand how much a frum ash ir has to be let's say you're a yeshiva man; you're sitting in the beis ham ed rash studying Torah and in walks one of the members of the Board of Directors. And he's wearing flashy clothes, checkered pants and a sports jacket. I don't know if he is, but well imagine it's so for our story. Now, you're wearing a black hat.



RABBI MILLER

You have a little beard. So in your heart, you look down at him maybe. He's a supporter of the yeshiva and you understand that if the business manager of the yeshiva is ushering him in, he's only flattering him in order to maintain the stream of donations to the yeshiva. But you - you are the yeshiva.

THE BACKUP PLAN



RABBI MILLER

You're making a big mistake. He's superior to you. This member of the Board of Directors is superior to you! He's been blessed min ha Shamayim with the opportunity to make so many people happy. He's supporting the yeshiva. What are you doing? You're just supporting yourself. He's supporting you. He's paying your rebbe. He's supporting the dining room that feeds you. He's supporting the dormitory. It was bestowed upon him this privilege of being mesameyach es habriyos. The Backup Plans Now, if you don't have lots of money, there are still thousands of ways. Simple things, easy opportunities.



RABBI MILLER

Let's say you send ten dollars every month to a talmid chacham in Meah Shearim. He lives perhaps in two rooms with a big family, and you send him ten dollars a month because you want to participate in his Torah lifestyle at least a little bit. Now, for a poor family like that, it's a big happiness when that little check arrives. But if in addition to the check you put into the envelope a little slip of paper or on the margin of the check, "Shalom uvrachah! You are the heart of our nation! So you've swelled that ten dollars into their lives.



RABBI MILLER

The ten dollars? Excellent! That's happiness. The extra words? A double happiness! And even with no money at all. The Gemara (Taanis 22a) tells a story that once Eliyahu appeared to a certain chacham in the marketplace. Now, it was a marketplace, not a yeshiva; it was a place of ordinary people and it was a remarkable thing that Eliyahu appeared to him davka there. We would expect Eliyahu to come to a holy place, a place of tefillah and Torah, maybe a house of tzaddikim. But in a marketplace? A place of goyim, ameihaaretz, ordinary people. It was out of the ordinary, and so this wise man utilized the opportunity.



RABBI MILLER

He said to Eliyahu, Is there anybody in this marketplace who is a ben Olam Haba?" Eliyahu said, "Yes, and he pointed to a man, a clown who was jumping up and down." That clown is a ben Olam Haba." So this chacham approached the clown and he started investigating and he discovered that the clown used to go and perform free of charge when he saw someone who was sad. He used to jump up and down to make him laugh, to make him happy.

HAPPINESS BEGINS AT HOME



RABBI MILLER

The Clown's Secret Now, this clown wasn't a rosh yeshiva. He wasn't even someone who supports the yeshiva. He was a clown. But because he was devoted to the middah of mesameyach es habriyos, Hakadosh Baruch Hu sent Eliyahu Hanavi to this chacham in a place which was not especially fit for Eliyahu Hanavi to come, in order to teach him the great lesson that every Jew, no matter who, is obligated in this program. Of course, if you're a baal Torah and you're a baal chess ed too, you find ways and means of making people happy - so Torah with chess ed together is unbeatable.



RABBI MILLER

Like it states in Bava Kamma (see 17a), if you have Torah and gemilus chassadim together, there's nothing that can compare to that. But here is a man who was doing only chess ed alone and still the navi said to the chacham, "He's a ben Olam Haba. That's how important it is. However, we'll have to add one more word what we said before, that this clown, whatever he did was because he wanted to emulate Hashem. Otherwise, it wouldn't help. It was 77 n." Hashem causes people happiness and He wants me also to emulate Him. That's the perfection of someone who makes other people happy.



RABBI MILLER

Happiness Begins at Home Now, an important point. Many altruists are busy making charity begins at home. The very best place to start is at home. Sometimes it's easier outside, so you can start practicing outside, but have in mind that you're aiming to do it at home, too. And maybe after a while it will start creeping into your own house, too. The home, that's the place you can add happiness. Make your wife and your children happy. Don't forget that. That's a career. It's your job to make a happy home. Sometimes it's not so easy; you have to plan it.

והלכת בדרךיו



HAPPY SKYSCRAPERS



RABBI MILLER

know, mothers are dealing with the children all day long, so they're worn out raw and therefore every little problem is magnified in her problem that all the problems of the world are dwarfed in comparison. And so the father has to make a joke out of it. Of course, he has to be careful to do it in such a way that she doesn't become the butt of the joke. But it has to be a joke - "It's not so serious; Chaim will one day be a big fat rabbi anyhow." Happy Skyscrapers And therefore, remember always that your best opportunity is with your own family.



RABBI MILLER

Make your wife happy. Make your husband happy. Make your children happy. It doesn't mean to give them expensive things. Of course, you have to provide. Make sure you earn enough money! If you don't bring money home, there's unhappiness in the house. But also, besides the bread, you have to give them a little bi of fun, too, a little nosh. Give your wife a few trinkets; remember from jewelry, buy costume jewelry. Buy little things for the children to keep (C hull in84b).



RABBI MILLER

And always, always, always -kind words! That's the very best thing! Always, always kind words. Always "thank you" and "please." Always compliments. And little by little, you build up not just a home but a skyscraper of mesameyach es habriyos. And that kind of accomplishment has no ge'vul, no boundary, how great the reward is. Part III. The Songster Spreads Happiness The Gift Table general principle in the halachos of spreading happiness, of being a songster in this world. Now, I don't know what the custom is today, but in the olden days when you attended a wedding there was a special table where they used to put the gifts.



RABBI MILLER

A Skyscraper Built Of Kind Words.

THE GIFT TABLE



RABBI MILLER

one brings a this."Thank you Whatever it is, all kinds of things are put on the table and the chosson and kallah are happy. The Inexpensive, Valuable Gift Now, let's say someone happens to be impecunious-it means he doesn't have any money. So here's an impecunious fellow standing near the table. He also came to the chasunah, but he has nothing to give. But as each gift is deposited on the table, he points out to the chosson and kallah what a valuable gift this is. inside?" The chosson and kallah are too busy looking at the size of the gifts.



RABBI MILLER

So he takes out the little slip that's packed in with the watch and he reads it to them. Seventeen jewels. Pure gold, 14-karat gold. Unbreakable crystal. Water-proof. Anti-magnetic. Inca bloc shock protection. It's a whole list of things that's packed in. Now, when he gets through reading, the chosson and kallah have received a better gift. By giving them this knowledge, the man who stands at the table where all the gifts are piled up is giving more than contribution is very important because they would take that watch and stuff it away in the valise, and after the chasunah they go off somewhere and forget all about it.



RABBI MILLER

If they'll ever use the watch, they won't appreciate it. But because of this man who sang the praises of the gifts, so all their lives, as long as they have these things, they're to them. And the more knowledge, the happier they'll be. The Treasure in the Cellar Now, sometimes you might have a gift that you're not aware of at all. Let me use a mashal that I told years ago. Suppose you bought a house, let's say, outside of Boro Park. Today it's expanding into Bensonhurst. The house used to belong to Italians and you bought it.



THE NON-JEWISH ITALIAN CALLER

THE HAPPY AMBASSADOR



RABBI MILLER

minute, I might croak. And so I want you to know that buried under the boards in the basement floor is a box full of jewelry and diamonds, golden coins. It's no good to me now so I'm letting you know. Better you get it than the government." He hangs up. You don't waste any time. "Where are you going" your wife says, "with a saw and a hammer and chisel and crowbars?" "An Italian just called me up." "You're crazy" she's saying. "You'll break up the floor because of a telephone call?!" "Never mind." And so you're rich now.



RABBI MILLER

But actually you were rich for the last twenty years that you lived in that house. You always had that property. It was yours. He couldn't claim it. But what made you wealthy? The telephone call made you rich; it's the knowledge of what you possess. The Happy Ambassador And therefore, we are all wealthy people, but it's buried under the cellar board of our minds - some people haven't the slightest idea what they possess.



RABBI MILLER

And now we begin to understand that giving people the knowledge, the awareness of all the good things Hakadosh Of course, you have to believe it first. o tell others, you have o first appreciate the happiness yourself. It means to begin being happy with all the appurtenances of life. Be happy that you're well! Be happy that you're married! Be happy with your home. Be happy with all the functions of your body; your eyes and your feet and your hands.



RABBI MILLER

Life is full of joys - only that you have to think about it; you have to prime the pump of happiness. Complaining and Paining Now, fur eml an r, gt out it ur jut th of what Hashem wants you to be.

WEATHER AS A FRIEND



RABBI MILLER

chambers of the belly. It means they're not superficial blows. He says, "Oh, it's too hot, too humid." He complains against the cold. "It's too windy. It's nasty, this rain." This is no good and that's no good. That inside of the belt. He's hitting people in the gut by complaining. The mitzvah of shiluach hakan teaches that instead of walking around and grouching, your function in the world is to let people know how good Hashem's world is. We should be songsters, always singing, chirping, about Hashem's beautiful world.



RABBI MILLER

Nota Fair-Weather Friend Sing the praises of the seasons. The hot weather means that the apples are being baked on the tree right now, becoming red and sweet. You can't cook in a kitchen without heat. The cherries and plums and s are ripening now on the fields, making the wheat ready for all the cakes and breads and challos, all the good things are coming up all winter long. We are going to eat the results of that heat. And so if we have to prepare our food, it means heat is good times!



RABBI MILLER

And the cold! Ah! As you're walking down the avenue enjoying the brisk Brooklyn air, let people know how good it is. Anyone who will listen. Your wife, your children, your chavirim, your students, whoever you can sing to, spread the good word! We need cold weather. The cold is for a purpose, to make people stop working in the fields; the fields have to rest and recuperate all the materials and energy they lost during the summer. If not for the cold, the earth would continue to produce all year round and would become exhausted of all its nourishment; it would become arid, a desert.



RABBI MILLER

And so it's a happiness when the winter comes and the earth can rest and recover all of its energies once more. The earth is getting ready to feed you again, to produce new crops, new fruits. Seasonal Songs And so all the seasons deserve their own song. When you walk in the street now, say, "Isn't it a wonderful August day!"

SEASONAL SONGS



RABBI MILLER

beautiful to sing about. You have to learn how to taste each season - each season has its the zest of the wind! Enjoy the slap of the rain on your face! Teach your children to look forward to the delicious quality of summer, to look forward to spring and to autumn. Learn to sing these songs; sing about how beautiful January is. How wonderful is February. We have to learn it and then spread the good word.



RABBI MILLER

How wonderful is this detail of life and that detail! How happy you should be for this and for that! Eternal Happiness And of course, once you get into the habit of spreading happiness, you'll sing to your fellow Jews about the real happiness. If a man explains to people how fortunate they are that they are Jews, that's - How fortunate is our lot in life! Now, saying those words should result in a little more happiness every day, but the man is saying it without the slightest expression of simcha in him.



RABBI MILLER

That's the result of habit. And so you have to go out and explain to people what it means to be chosen as a Jew. You're a prince! You're bnei Keil chai! You're called "children of the Living G-d." You belong to the Am Olam, the eternal nation. Eternal means in both That's the greatest happiness of all. Let's say you would be invited - of course, you wouldn't go - to a gathering of literati somewhere on Park Avenue, a cocktail dinner being given, It's say, on the appearance of a certain new book that somebody wrote.



RABBI MILLER

The author is there; and they're all drinking 'chaim -

HAPPILY EVER AFTER



RABBI MILLER

But there's always an undercurrent of sadness because they know that all this is going to come to an end. Not only afterwards when they walk out at two o'clock in the morning on a dark street. They don't want to admit it, but they feel at the bottom of their hearts that there'll be a day when they'll put him in the box and bury him in the ground. That's the end. That's the greatest sadness. And once a man admitted it. One of them once admitted it. He said, 'Despite everything, all of our happiness turns to ashes when we realize that all this ends in the grave.' There can't be any happiness if you know that it'll come to an end. Even if a man will have a thousand years, the specter, the fear of that final conclusion of his life, to go into the ground, embitters all of his joy. It robs him of happiness.



RABBI MILLER

It's an intimation of the future. When you'll sit in your sukkah and you're rejoicing with your family and you're singing Yom Tov songs, you instinctively feel that this is only a preview of what's going to come.



RABBI MILLER

Happily Ever After. And so how important it is to tell our fellow Jew about Olam Haba! How important it is to implant that happiness in the minds of our children! You have to make them understand the great wealth of being a member of the Chosen People, how fortunate he is. Everything in this world is transformed when we know that it's going to extend into the world beyond and last forever.



RABBI MILLER

Oh yes! If we want to engage in the practice of mesameyach es habriyos, the greatest form is to enlighten your fellow men how fortunate they are, not only by what they possess in all the gifts of life, but what they possess in the gifts of Hakadosh Baruch Hu, the Torah and Olam Haba! When people hear all these things, if it's explained to them sufficiently, their eyes begin to glow with happiness. Their hearts begin to beat with joy. They are transformed into happy people. You are giving them a gift of da'as and it's more precious than a box of diamonds concealed under the basement floor. The Segulah for Yom Hadin. Now pay attention. It's so essential to include this system of mesameyach es habriyos

RAV MILLER'S HANGHADAH



THE CHEERFUL KOSHER GROCER

he should make himself be considered important by Hakadosh Baruch 1, that the pub lie needs him. If you re a man whom the public needs, then you have a very big merit an daze chu s hakiyum. It'sn good reason why you deserve tobe around longer. Now, you might think that it means a rosh yeshiva maybe. It's true. The public needs him. It's good to be a rosh yeshiva if you can be one Maybe therav of a s hula good, frumrav.



HE PREPARES HIS GOODS WITH CARE

Yes, that's also something. But there are other ways of rabim tzrichim lo. Rav Miller's Hashgacha Suppose you'rea grocer. Iam thinking of a certain grocer who's him, but I've been noticing his ways for at least twenty years. He always has a smile on his face and always speaks pleasantly to people That's a man that the rabim tzrichim lo. Not only for his groceries; they need him because he's a kindly, friendly man.



CUSTOMERS LEAVE HAPPIER

Everybody needs a friendly man. They look forward to that. If you get into the habit of giving words of encouragement, it's certainly rabi m tz ric him lo. Plan out ways and means of telling people how fortunate they are tobe alive! How fortunate they are to have lungs and free air and legs that take them wherever they want to go. That they can go to the bathroom b'shalom and they can sleep peacefully at night.



A NEIGH

THE PUBLIC BENEFACTOR



RABBI MILLER

Hashem said, "I'm going to command My nation to take special care of you; to spare you and send you free so that you can continue your song. "You're making My people happy! That's My plan in the world! You're walking in My footsteps and helping Me!



RABBI MILLER

And therefore I'll take care of you. I'm going to reward you for that." And so, anybody who sings in this world, anyone who is busy trying to make the world a happier place - he's going to be saved. Because the mother bird, she's spared merely for her instinct, but the man who chooses with his free will to make a career of mesameyach es habriyos, he surely deserves to be spared. And not only spared -he deserves a great many things because he's making Hashem's world a more happy place.



Rabbi Miller holds the Torah as throngs of men and children dance around him outside his synagogue on Kings Highway, Brooklyn.